Reading Comprehension: Fiction & Poetry

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Literal Retrieval & Vocabulary

1. The cold glass of the attic window.
2. A) It moved in quick, light, unsteady flaps
3. Thick dust.
4. A wave.
5. His grandson.
6. A) It tipped or jolted suddenly and unsteadily
7. Stallholders shouting prices and a fiddler playing a jig (also acceptable: a dog barking).
8. A) It was full of busy, lively activity and noise
9. A, B and C (the fiddler, the dog, and the smell of chestnuts are all mentioned; rain and a church bell are not).
10. It made the golden heads of wheat bow (bend down).
11. They scattered from the speaker's feet.
12. A) A soft, quiet, hushed sound
13. Her homework diary.
14. The bell rang.
15. She worried that she might have forgotten something important for school.

Inference, Mood & Character

16. He was impatient, annoyed or anxious about being late.
17. A) He is quietly frustrated or irritated
18. He kept his coat on and checked his watch repeatedly.
19. He is frightened or nervous, even though he tries to reassure himself.
20. A) Tense and unsettling
21. That it was just the floorboards settling.
22. She is angry and frustrated, and feels a sense of injustice.
23. A, B and C (she is calm/quiet (D) and someone arguing back (E) are not supported).
24. To show how strongly Jess feels, even without an audience, emphasising the depth of her frustration.
25. The speaker feels lonely or isolated.
26. A) Lonely and reflective
27. The gulls.
28. She is calm, patient, and forgiving — not easily angered.
29. 'Well, now we know it was never glued very well, don't we?'
30. She is trying to make light of the accident and reassure Tom, rather than blame him.

Figurative Language & Devices

31. 'moved like a rusty gate' — compares the dog's stiff, creaking movement to a rusty gate.
32. A) His body has aged but his playful spirit has not
33. It suggests he moves slowly, stiffly and with difficulty, as if his joints are rusty.
34. 'Her anger was a kettle left too long on the stove' — compares her building anger to a kettle heating up and then boiling over.

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35. A) It builds slowly and quietly before suddenly erupting
36. Because the anger seems calm and controlled at first, people are caught off guard when it suddenly becomes loud and uncontrollable — like a kettle that seems fine until it suddenly whistles loudly.
37. The house is described as 'groaning' and being 'tired of standing guard', as if it were a living, weary being.
38. A, B and D (it does not prove the house is about to collapse, and it does not show nobody has lived there).
39. A) It has stood through many winters and feels worn out by time
40. They rhyme with each other (a rhyming pattern — 'waits'/'gates' and 'pain'/'again' also rhyme).
41. The steady, repeated rhythm mimics the ticking of a clock and suggests that time moves on relentlessly and unstoppably, regardless of human feelings.
42. Rhythm that imitates the sound of a clock, creating a steady, mechanical, unstoppable feel.
43. 'legs pumping like pistons on an engine gone wild' — compares his legs' movement to engine pistons.
44. A) He is running at maximum effort and feels physically overwhelmed
45. It is an exaggeration used for effect — his heart will not literally burst; the phrase conveys how extremely hard he is running and how intense the exertion feels.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Literal Retrieval & Vocabulary

1. Scuttling sideways into a hole.
2. Waist-deep in the sea, further out.
3. A) Quick, scurrying, sideways movement
4. Cinnamon and burnt toast.
5. Humming an old tune (while baking/cooking).
6. A) It lightly covered her apron in a thin white layer
7. Whose turn it was on the swing.
8. Building a tower of pebbles in the sandpit.
9. A, B and D (a dog running past and rain falling are not mentioned).
10. It blinks its light across the sea, acting as a steady guide/friend to ships.
11. A restless, rolling sea.
12. A) The sea is constantly moving and never still
13. He tapped the whiteboard twice.
14. 'Books away.'
15. A) An unusual change from the normal lesson routine

Inference, Mood & Character

16. He is nervous or anxious about the exam.
17. A) His leg bouncing under the desk
18. He is anxious about time running out / wishes he had more time.
19. He has mixed feelings — he is happy on the surface but may also feel a little sad, left out or uncertain underneath.
20. A) He hides some of his true feelings in front of others
21. He has become quieter than usual.
22. She is frightened or anxious about thunderstorms.
23. A, B and D (she does not enjoy thunderstorms, and she is not described as alone).
24. She pulls her blanket tighter and counts slowly to ten.
25. The speaker is hopeful and optimistic, trusting that better times (spring) will come.
26. A) Hopeful
27. Winter is currently described; the speaker is confident that spring will follow.
28. She is calm, encouraging, and focuses on positives rather than blame.
29. 'What's one thing we did well today?'
30. A) The players felt able to engage positively despite the loss

Standard / Advanced

31. 'Silence' and 'screamed' are opposites (an oxymoron), suggesting the silence was so intense or tense that it felt as overwhelming as a loud noise — showing extreme tension or unease.
32. A) It is rough, harsh, and may hint at an older or more weathered speaker
33. It suggests the leaves are reddish/orange like embers, and that summer (warmth and life) is fading away or coming to an end, just as embers are the last glow before a fire goes out.
34. It suggests his pride shields him from being hurt or shown as weak, while also hinting that underneath the pride he may be hiding insecurity or vulnerability.
35. It combines the idea that the wind moved gently and softly through the grass with the human action of combing, as if the wind were tenderly running fingers through hair.

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36. 'A map of scars' — compares his face to a map, with scars as its markings; 'eyes, pale as sea-glass' — compares his eye colour to sea-glass; 'lit up like a boy's' — compares his excited expression to that of a young boy (any two).

37. A) He is an experienced, weathered man who still retains a youthful passion for the sea

38. It suggests his face shows the history of his life's experiences and hardships the way a map shows routes and places, with each scar representing a past event or 'storm'.

39. Personification: 'The city never slept'; Metaphor: the traffic described as 'an endless river of light and noise' (the neon signs blinking 'like tired eyes' is a simile).

40. A, B and C (the extract does contain figurative language, and the buildings are not described as roaring — the traffic is).

41. A) A restless, constantly active and overwhelming place

42. 'Grief sat on her shoulders like a sack of stones' — compares the weight/burden of grief to carrying a heavy sack of stones.

43. It suggests that grief does not disappear, and its intensity varies from day to day, but some level of sadness or burden always remains, even on better days.

44. Simile: 'branches, like gnarled old hands'; Personification: the branches 'reaching out... as though trying to shelter every traveller'.

45. A) An ancient, protective, almost human presence watching over the lane

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